

Anas Koujout

Master's student (M1) in Artificial Intelligence, [University], [City, Country]
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[Date]

Selection Committee, Research Internships for International Students 2026–2027
USherbrooke International, Université de Sherbrooke, Sherbrooke (Québec), Canada

Subject: Application for a 4-month research internship (offers 2027-010, 2027-015 and 2027-024)

Dear Members of the Selection Committee,

I am a first-year master's student in Artificial Intelligence at [University], and I am applying for a 4-month research internship at the Université de Sherbrooke through the partner internship program. My three choices are **2027-010** (audio classification with a spiking neural network on FPGA, Pr. Fabien Alibert and Pr. Jean Rouat), **2027-015** (adaptive loco-manipulation on a Unitree Go2, Pr. Wael Suleiman) and **2027-024** (spiking neural networks on FPGA for energy data, Pr. Fabien Alibert). They share the direction I want to give my career: artificial intelligence that leaves the server and runs on real, constrained systems.

What attracts me most is the step between a model that works in a notebook and a model that works in the real world. Spiking neural networks offer a credible path toward low-power AI at the edge, and turning a pre-trained network into a synthesized FPGA implementation, as proposed in 2027-010, is exactly the kind of engineering challenge I want to learn from. In the same way, the Go2 project asks a question I find fascinating: can a compact, learned estimate of the robot's dynamic context keep a whole-body controller stable when the load, the contacts and the gap between simulation and reality all change at once? Working at the 3IT, alongside groups such as NECOTIS and the humanoid and collaborative robotics laboratory, would give me the opportunity to work on these questions in a demanding research environment.

My master's program has given me a solid foundation in machine learning and deep learning, with hands-on experience in [Python, PyTorch, C++ ... keep only what is true]. [One sentence on a concrete project: what you built, with which tools, and the result]. I learn new tools quickly and I am comfortable reading scientific papers in English, which I consider essential for contributing to an active research project.

I am aware that these offers are primarily intended for second-year master's students. To make up for this difference, I am committed to preparing before my arrival: studying the groups' previous work, such as the publications of Yarga et al. on PDM processing and SNN acceleration, and getting familiar with the project tools (high-level synthesis for FPGA, Isaac Lab and ROS 2), so that I can be productive from the first day of the internship. I would be grateful if my application could be considered on this basis.

Thank you for your time and consideration. I would be glad to discuss my motivation and my preparation in an interview. Please find my CV and transcripts enclosed.

Sincerely,

Anas Koujout